Balanced Instruction & Healthy Technology Use

November 4 2026



What Is “Healthy Technology Use”?

Screen Time / Value

Reflect current state and build for the future, specific to usage guidelines in the classroom as well as digital literacy for our students.

Filtering & Monitoring

Protect students, ensure data privacy, align work online to curriculum needs and best practices - remove the wide variability across classrooms.

Generative AI

Balanced approach toward gradual introduction to AI literacy and use to prepare students for critical thinking

Digital Literacy

Engage and partner with our educators and parents to implement research-based best practices that increase student awareness and safety

Today’s discussion

Why This Is Important

PPS's Policies and Processes are Out of Date with Current Use of Tech

Align & Support School Staff for More Intentional Use of Tech

Protect Students through strong Data Privacy Practices and Tighter Controls

Implement Digital Literacy Curriculum to Prepare for the Current State, Provide Skills for the Future State

In the 1890s, people actually thought bicycles would make women **immoral**.



When bicycles became popular, especially among women, they caused a lot of controversy.

Many critics said cycling gave women **too much independence.**

Women could now travel without a chaperone, meet people outside the home, and move freely in ways that weren't acceptable at the time.



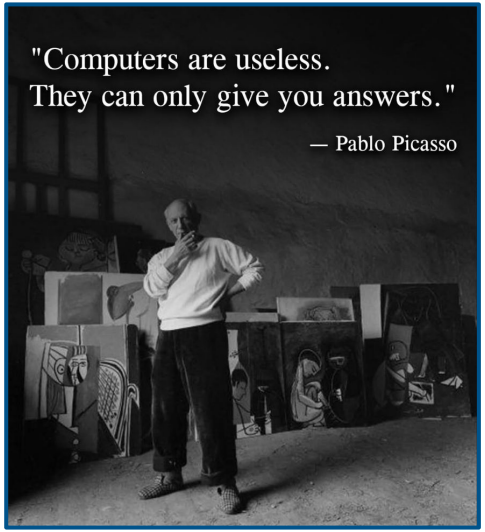
Some newspapers and commentators claimed that bicycles encouraged **immorality** and would disrupt traditional family values.

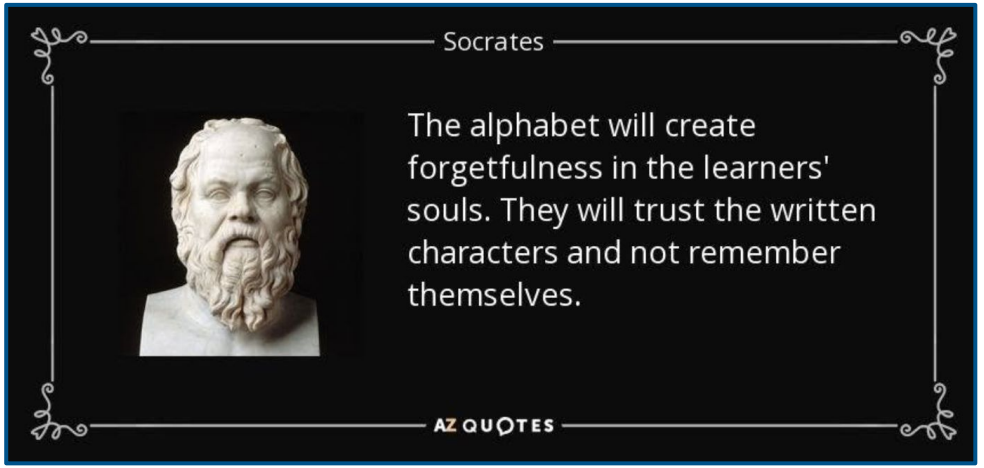
There were also concerns about the new cycling clothing, which was more practical and less restrictive than traditional dresses.



But women kept riding.

And instead of destroying society, the bicycle became one of the technologies that helped change how women moved through the world — giving them more freedom, independence, and opportunity.





Recent Timeline

September '25

AI Planning Committee started

Cross organizational group of central office and school staff along with parent and student advisory input

June 23

Board Meeting *(budget review)*

Resolution introduced to pause on AI in the classroom, report back in October, etc.

August 25

Screen Time Guidelines

Guidance posted online regarding grade band level guidance and best practices

October 27

Policy Committee Mtg.

Present an updated Resolution that includes:

- Screen Time
- AI use
- Filtering & Monitoring

November 4

Board Meeting

Present response to Resolution from June 23rd meeting

Student Chromebooks:
All K-8 grades to in-classroom carts (not 1:1)

Partnership across Academics, Technology, building leaders, teachers, and parents.

Detailed Response



AI Pause:
Directive #1 and #2

(1) "Pause the execution of any new contracts, contract amendments, subscriptions, pilot programs, software licenses, or procurement actions primarily related to GenAI technologies"

- At time of the resolution, none of the above was planned
- No change since the time of the resolution
- No current plans to do anything regarding GenAI in the classroom

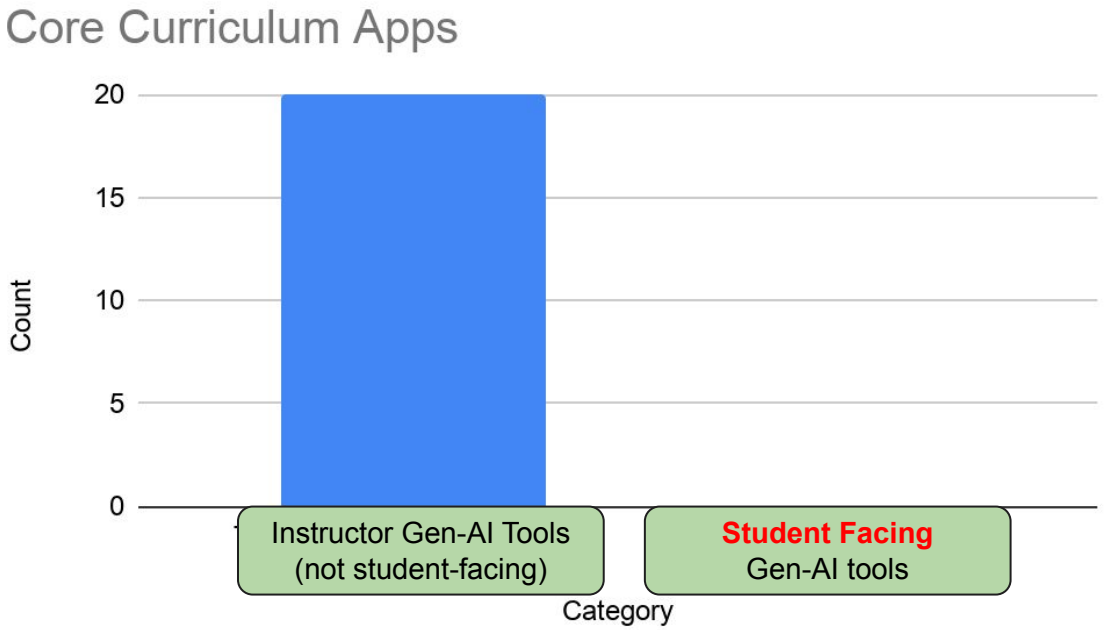
(2) "Pause the expansion of existing GenAI technology implementations beyond their current scope of work"

- At time of the resolution, none of the above was planned
- No change since the time of the resolution
- No current plans to do anything regarding GenAI in the classroom

"This pause shall not apply to cybersecurity, accessibility, or software maintenance functions that do not materially expand GenAI capabilities and/or are not student-interactive."

AI Pause Directive #3

"Prepare an Inventory of APPROVED Existing Student-Facing GenAI Implementations



Core Curriculum Apps

Teaching-Facing

- GenAI apps = 20
- Non genAI apps = 34
- Total apps = 54

Student-Facing

- GenAI Apps = 0

***Apps for CTE follow the app vetting approval process and align to industry standard for the CTE program and courses.**

***All PPS core content curriculum apps that have optional student-facing Gen AI features have been disabled by PPS**

AI Pause Directive #4

Educational Technology Contracts and Data Sharing Agreements

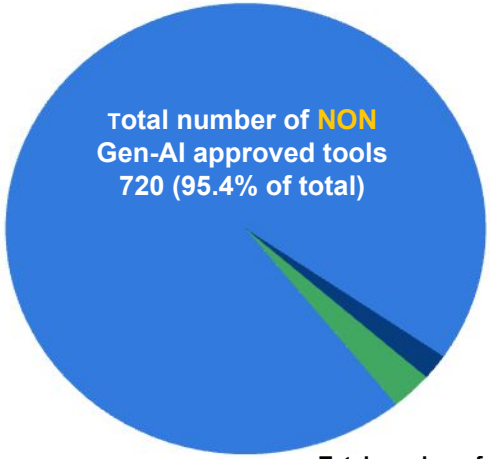
"Work to amend all existing educational technology contracts and data-sharing agreements to prohibit third-party vendors from collecting or sharing personally identifiable student data unless expressly required by law."

- FERPA language is included in every Professional Services Agreement and all purchasing agreement Terms & Conditions
- This highlights the critical reason why all software needs to be approved by central office staff per the current process with centralized review, approval, tracking and oversight.

AI Pause Directive #5a

Inventory of all tools, platforms, software products, pilots, and services currently used throughout all of PPS

Important
None of these tools are student-facing



Google Gemini
- Use Case: Productivity Tools
- Active Staff: 2,000
- Included with Google Workspace licenses at $6/user/year.

Central Office GenAI Tools
- Use Case: Productivity Tools
- Active Staff: 450
- Smartsheet, AXIS3 (SPED), CIM (Facilities)
- Cybersecurity (OTIS)

All Remaining Tools
- Usage is limited to specific use cases
- Active Staff: 9,700 (ever, not concurrent)

AI Pause Directive #5b & #5c

5b: All associated contracts, costs, funding sources, and renewal dates

5c: Description of all student, employee, and PPS data shared with associated vendors

Important
None of these tools are student-facing

5b: Full details in posted Board materials

5c: Data

- All approved software (instructional or otherwise) has restrictive language regarding data usage and privacy as part of every Professional Services Agreement, including FERPA
- *NOTE:* PPS Academics, OTIS, & Legal departments recommend stronger Policy or Administrative Directive language to reduce unapproved software in the classroom, as it does not follow approved vetting and procurement processes and controls.

AI Pause Directive #5d

Recommendations regarding future implementation, limitations, or expansion of GenAI technologies within PPS

Knowledge of AI should be treated similar to a required language

PPS should integrate developmentally appropriate Digital Literacy instruction into the core curriculum for grades K–12, starting in the 2027-28 school year

- Evaluating source credibility and detecting misinformation
- Understanding data privacy and responsible use
- The environmental and social impacts of digital technologies
- Safe and respectful use of digital tools, including social media
- Skills to critically evaluate digital content
- Developing critical thinking, creativity, communication, collaboration, empathy, judgment, and independent problem-solving skills in a rapidly evolving technological world
- Maintaining healthy technology habits, including attention management, periodic breaks, ergonomics, and awareness of persuasive or engagement-focused design.

Questions

